



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Quick Response Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

Title: JCF Quick Response Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Identification Code : JCF/FW/PL/Ops/0025/2025
Effective Date: F.O. No. 4085 dated 2025-09-18	Pages: 8
Review Date: Nil	Distribution: Force Wide
Revision No.: 0	Process Owners: Deputy Commissioner of Police, Strategic Operations Portfolio
Rescinds: Nil	
Authors: Strategic Operations Portfolio, PRDB	Owner: Jamaica Constabulary Force
First Published: F.O. No. 4085 dated 2025-9-18	Review: Biennially

Table of Contents

1.0	Introduction	3
2.0	Purpose	3
3.0	Scope	3
4.0	Policy Statement.....	3
5.0	Abbreviations and Acronyms	3
6.0	Definitions	4
7.0	Responsibilities	4
8.0	Standard Operating Procedures	5
9.0	Legislative Authority / Guiding Principles	7
	APPENDIX 1: Organizational Chart: Quick Response Unit	8

1.0 Introduction

High population density, traffic congestion, narrow streets, and varied terrain across Jamaica present challenges for law enforcement responding to emergency situations using motor cars or pick-ups. Motorcycles have proven more suitable to address these challenges, as they afford the required agility and speed necessary to navigate congested streets.

This policy provides guidance and outlines directives to govern the Jamaica Constabulary Force's Quick Response Unit (QRU). The QRU responds to unusual or critical, rapidly evolving incidents and supports other divisions and units within the Jamaica Constabulary Force in crime prevention activities.

The QRU is required to focus on crime prevention and arrest offenders. Members of the QRU are expected to be adept at effecting arrests, seizing prohibited weapons, and recovering stolen vehicles and other properties. The main arm of the QRU is the Metro Quick Response Unit, which forms part of the Public Safety Division (PSD) of the Public Safety and Traffic Enforcement Branch (PSTEB).

2.0 Purpose

This Policy and Standard Operating Procedures for the Management of Quick Response Teams outlines the JCF's established guidelines for the QRUs. It ensures that resources are effectively and efficiently optimized and aligned with established protocols and standards, maintaining consistency and reliability in operations.

3.0 Scope

This Policy and Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force and the Rural Police Force. It establishes the communication and coordination frameworks within the QRU to facilitate effective operations.

4.0 Policy Statement

The Jamaica Constabulary Force is committed to ensuring the safety, security, and well-being of all citizens through the rapid and effective deployment of QRUs. This policy emphasizes professionalism, accountability, and adherence to established protocols in maintaining public trust.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

JCF	-	Jamaica Constabulary Force
PECC	-	Police Emergency Communication Centre
PSD	-	Public Safety Division
PSTEB	-	Public Safety and Traffic Enforcement Branch
QRU	-	Quick Response Unit

6.0 Definitions

6.1 Quick Response

The immediate and coordinated action taken by specialized teams to address emergencies, critical incidents, or high-risk situations.

6.2 Quick Response Unit

A specialized motorcycle team that is mandated and resourced to swiftly respond to sudden threats to public safety and criminal activities.

6.3 Response Time

This is the duration between the receipt of an assignment and the time of arrival.

7.0 Responsibilities

The following summarizes critical responsibilities:

7.1 The Deputy Commissioner of Police, Strategic Operations Portfolio, exercises oversight over all operational resources of the JCF.

7.2 The Assistant Commissioner of Police Public Safety and Traffic Enforcement Branch (PSTEB) has oversight of the Quick Response Units (QRU).

7.3 Commanding Officer, Public Safety Division (PSD) is responsible for:

7.3.1 the superintendence of the PSD;

7.3.2 the strategic direction of the PSD in alignment with the branch priorities of PSTEB; and

7.3.3 the growth, impact and relevance of the QRU.

7.4 The Operations Officer, PSD is responsible for:

7.4.1 supervising and coordinating operational activities;

7.4.2 developing and implementing strategic plans to carry out effective operations;

7.4.3 ensuring that all data relating to the activities of each team is collated daily and submitted to the statistics unit, PSTEB at the end of each shift; and

7.4.4 ensuring that the teams are properly resourced with vehicles and equipment.

7.5 The Administration Officer, PSD is responsible for managing the performance, discipline, training and welfare of members attached to the QRUs.

7.6 Metro Quick Response Unit Sub-Officer is responsible for:

7.6.1 communicating to the Operations Officer i/c the QRU regarding the operations within the zones of deployment;

7.6.2 providing support to the zones of deployment as needed; and

7.6.3 conducting monthly visits of QRUs that are deployed to operate in the different zones.

7.7 Quick Response Units are responsible for:

- 7.7.1 responding to reports of critical incidents, *inter alia* murders, shootings, robberies, major collisions, and fires;
- 7.7.2 strategically positioning and profiling within their defined spaces to prevent and deter the commission of serious crimes;
- 7.7.3 providing reports, supporting statements and attending court when required;
- 7.7.4 conducting searches of persons and premises, which includes targeted and snap raids;
- 7.7.5 observing suspicious activities, detaining suspects and apprehending the accused;
- 7.7.6 participating in high-profile operations, when required;
- 7.7.7 conducting all activities with a high level of discipline and conformity to JCF's standards;
- 7.7.8 reporting their response time to the Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC);
- 7.7.9 reporting to PECC (and other relevant persons) on conclusion of an assignment.
- 7.7.10 documenting all incidents that occurred during the tour of duty; and
- 7.7.11 submitting reports on all incidents which occurred during the tour of duty.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

To achieve the mandate of the Quick Response Units, the following Standard Operating Procedures should be adhered

8.1 Preparation for Duty

- 8.1.1 Members should be paraded, inspected and briefed before being deployed for duty;
- 8.1.2 Daily Maintenance tasks should be conducted on service vehicles as per JCF Policy and SOP;
- 8.1.3 Members deployed for duty should only be armed with firearms that they are trained and qualified to carry.
- 8.1.4 Quick Response operatives who are trained in the use and care of body worn cameras should wear a camera on each tour of duty. Members are required to adhere to the procedures outlined in the JCF Policy and Standard Operating Procedures for the Management of Body-worn Cameras.

8.2 Conduct of members of the QRU

- 8.2.1 No one member of a Quick Response Unit should be seen operating a motorcycle without being accompanied by other team members.
- 8.2.2 Quick Response personnel should not visit spirit licensed premises, casinos/betting shops, and remain on any such premises for extended periods unless engaged in their primary duties.
- 8.2.3 Quick Response Unit personnel should only operate motorcycles professionally (according to training, Force Policy, and the Law). They

should not display stunt skills, except where the organization sanctioned members' participation in such activities.

- 8.2.4 No private police duties must be undertaken without the approval of the Commanding Officer PSD.
- 8.2.5 All operations performed by Quick Response Operatives must be in keeping with their mandate. Members of the Quick Response should not participate in any external targeted raids unless the Commanding Officer PSD has given approval.
- 8.2.6 Members of the QRU are allowed to wear face covers during operational duties, but they should remove them when interacting with the public.
- 8.2.7 Protective headgears are to be worn by members of the QRUs whilst operating a motorcycle.

8.3 Assignment of QRUs

- 8.3.1 When given assignments from police stations or PECC, team leaders must report their arrival time and the time of the assignment's conclusion to the police station or PECC that gave the assignment.
- 8.3.2 All major operations of QRUs should be approved by ACP PSTEB.
- 8.3.3 All major crime scenes/incidents that are responded to by the QRU must immediately be reported to the Unit Supervisor at PSD.
- 8.3.4 The first responding QRU to a scene/incident should adhere to the response times as per Priority 1 and 2, as stipulated by the JCF Patrol and Emergency Response Policy and SOP.
- 8.3.5 Where the QRU is the first responder on the scene, they should be relieved as soon as the local police arrive.
- 8.3.6 No fewer than three (3) members of the QRUs should be deployed or respond to an assignment.
- 8.3.7 At no time should two QRU personnel be engaged in the use of one (1) motorcycle when performing their duties.
- 8.3.8 Members should not be engaged in funeral escorts or any other type of escort.

8.4 Reporting Procedures

- 8.4.1 All activities of each team must be collated by the unit's supervisor and submit to the Statistical Unit at TSD at the end of each shift.
- 8.4.2 All accidents and incidents involving members of the Quick Response during their tour of duty must be reported immediately and in keeping with Force Policy.
- 8.4.3 A report of all incidents that occur during the tour of duty must be submitted to the supervisor within **twenty-four (24) hours** of occurrence.

8.5 Training

8.5.1 Members assigned to the QRU are required to receive specialized training.

8.5.2 Members of the QRU should participate in structured training programmes.

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

9.16 The Firearms Act

9.17 The Jamaica Constabulary Force Act

9.18 The Dangerous Drugs Act

9.19 Policy and SOP for the Management of Body-worn Cameras

9.20 The Road Traffic Act

9.21 Human Rights and Police Use of Force and Firearm Policy

9.22 Diversity Policy

9.23 Ethics and Integrity Policy

9.24 Police Public Interaction Policy

APPENDIX 1: Organizational Chart: Quick Response Unit

